

## SCALER

### Brief for your next step

Hey Rohan, good speaking with you today. You asked sharper questions than most people I talk to -- the Andrew Ng comparison, the LLM depth question -- so I wanted to send you something that actually answers them instead of the usual deck.

### Your questions answered

1

What does Rs.3.5L get you that Coursera does not?

Andrew Ng's courses are genuinely good -- no argument there. But you already have 4 YoE, an AWS cert, and the discipline to self-study, and you are still asking 'am I too late?' That gap is not a content problem, it is a structure and signal problem. Scaler gives you live classes 3x a week with industry instructors, 1:1 mentorship with active practitioners, and 50+ hands-on projects -- not watched videos you finish at 1am and then forget. More importantly, it gives you a credible signal to product companies: a structured program with 900+ hiring partners and a 100,000+ alumni network carries weight that a Coursera certificate does not in a product company screening call.

2

Will the salary jump actually be meaningful for someone at your level?

You were direct about this on the call: 14 to 16 LPA at another service company makes the math fail, and that is the right way to think about it. I will be equally direct: I cannot quote you a personal salary number because outcomes depend on your role target, the companies you interview at, and how you perform -- and I would rather be honest than give you a figure that turns out to be wrong. What I can tell you is that Scaler publishes a median salary hike of around 110% for the DS/ML track. For your specific profile -- 4 YoE SDE-2, AWS cert, targeting AI engineering at product companies -- the admissions team can walk you through placement benchmarks that are actually relevant to you. That is a conversation worth having before you decide anything.

3

RAG, agents, evals -- is this actually in the curriculum or just marketing?

This was your sharpest question and it deserves a straight answer. The curriculum explicitly includes Prompt Engineering, RAG, and Multi-agent orchestration under the AI and Agents module, plus an Agentic AI elective -- these are listed program components, not vague 'AI exposure' add-ons. You said you want to build real LLM applications, and the curriculum is structured around end-to-end applied work, not theoretical ML foundations alone. How deep each module goes and what the current cohort's project scope looks like is something admissions can show you in detail -- I would ask them specifically about the Agentic AI elective given what you told me you want to build.

4

You are not too late -- but the window is not infinite either

You asked 'am I already too late?' on the call, and the honest answer is no -- but the people who will be too late are the ones who spend another year watching the wave from the shore. You already have the foundation: CSE degree, 4 years of real engineering work, an AWS cert, and the self-awareness to know service work is not where you want to be. The entrance test is the next concrete step -- it is not a barrier, it is what gets you into the room where the actual program details, cohort fit, and placement specifics get discussed. Take it, see where you stand, and then make the call with full information.

Today

Your current compensation depends on role and city. Happy to personalize on your next call.

Target path

Stronger product and tech-facing roles depend on effort and market. We share realistic bands with admissions, not guesses.

NOW

Skills audit & entrance clarity

0-4 MO

Core foundations & habits

4-8 MO

Depth projects & design

8-12 MO

Interview readiness

Take the entrance test when you are ready -- it is the one step that unlocks the full picture and gets you to a real conversation about your options.

Prepared for Rohan Sharma · 08 May 2026 · Scaler Academy